

Document 18: Diphtheria - Symptoms and Immunization

Diphtheria is a serious bacterial infection caused by *Corynebacterium diphtheriae*. It primarily affects the throat and upper airways, producing a thick gray membrane that can block breathing. Other symptoms include sore throat, fever, swollen glands, and weakness. Diphtheria can cause severe complications such as myocarditis and nerve damage. The disease is preventable through vaccination (DPT vaccine), which is part of routine childhood immunization schedules. Prompt administration of antitoxin and antibiotics is required for treatment.